

Individual Reflection Report (Erfahrungsbericht) Project: Kalender Netzwerk

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1. General

My motivation for taking part in this interdisciplinary module was that I wanted to work on a practical project and not only on theoretical assignments. I was interested in gaining experience in a real team setting where people from different academic backgrounds work together on one shared goal. I chose the Kalender Netzwerk project because it combines a useful real-world idea with technical challenges that are relevant to my field, especially backend development and system implementation.

In the group, my main role was related to the backend side of the project. I mainly contributed to the technical foundation of the system by focusing on server-side logic and how different parts of the application can work together. From my computer science background, I was able to contribute especially to the implementation-oriented side of the project. This means I was mostly involved in thinking about how the system should process requests and how the technical structure could support future development.

One of the most important things I learned during the module was that interdisciplinary project work is quite different from working only on technical tasks. In technical courses, the main focus is usually on solving the problem itself. In this project, I learned that communication, coordination, and flexibility are just as important as technical skills. I also learned that project ideas often need to change over time when the first approach does not work as expected.

2. Project Process and Organization.

In my opinion, frequent communication within the team was one of the largest positive features of the process in the group. The weekly meetings were beneficial because they kept everyone informed, and it became easier to discuss problems at an early stage. They also assisted in relating the technical aspects of the project to the wider project objectives. I believe that the diversity of the group's background was also a strength, as it contributed to bringing different thinking and different skills to the project.

At the same time, there were also some challenges. One of the challenges was that some of the initial methods appeared to be helpful initially but proved to be less efficient in the future. This decreased the pace and forced one to reconsider some aspects of the project. The other problem was the fact that interdisciplinary teamwork might need more explanation and coordination, particularly, when technical issues have to be communicated with individuals belonging to other backgrounds. I believe that this is a natural aspect of the interdisciplinary work, yet it is still time and work-consuming.

In general, I believe that the structure of the module helped me learn in a beneficial manner. I also appreciated that the module was founded on a real project and there were presentations and written reflection since this helped the work to feel more coherent and purposeful throughout the semester. The opportunity to use technical knowledge in a team was the greatest contributor to my learning process. What complicated this there were times when certain expectations were not always so concrete, particularly on the extent to which the technical outputs needed to be detailed as compared to the overall project objectives.

I believe that the module was organized in a generally good way, since it was a mix of practical and reflection. The input sessions and discussion opportunities came in handy when they assisted us to have a better idea of the project direction. The lecturer support was also helpful and particularly when the team had questions or needed to be oriented. A way to improve it would be to provide more guidance on the amount of technical detail that is required of students with software-related positions, since then the balance between implementation work and reporting would be easier to maintain.

3. Learning and competence development.

This project helped me acquire technical and personal skills. Technically, I acquired greater expertise in considering software systems as unified systems rather than as a collection of one-off coding assignments. I got to know more about the need to design the work of the backend in a manner that facilitates future development and integration. On a personal level, I became better at collaborating in a team, communicating technical concepts more succinctly, and being flexible when the plan of a project was altered. I believe these experiences will be useful for me in future study projects and also in my professional career. The project also allowed me to realize that the practice of software development is not only about coding, but also about teamwork, planning, and flexibility to adapt to the actual conditions of the project. I believe that this particularly helps in future employment in the field of software development or any other computer science-related job where both technical and interpersonal skills need to be present.